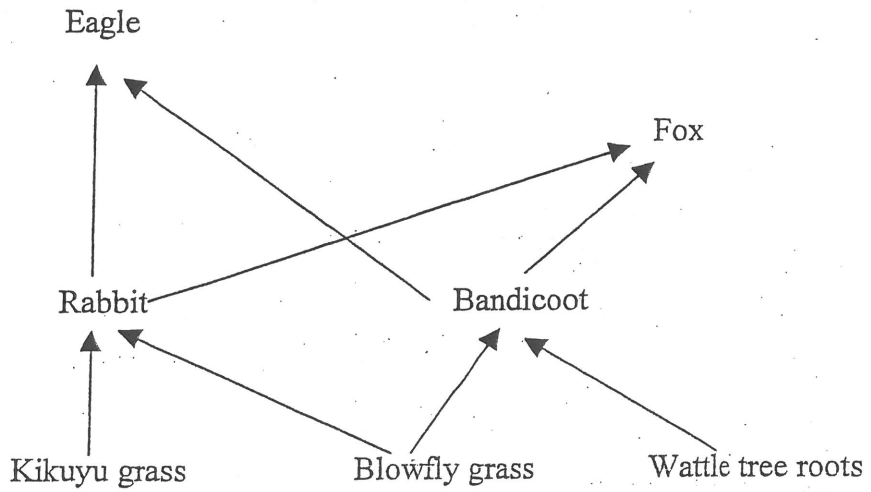
Food Webs

If you think about the foods that you eat you will realize that you are part of a number of interlocking food chains. When all the food chains for a community are shown linked together a **food web** formed.
The various levels in the food web are called **trophic** levels. Plants capture the sun's energy and this energy passes to herbivores and then to carnivores. Decomposers complete the flow of energy through the community.

This exercise refers to the food web drawn below.



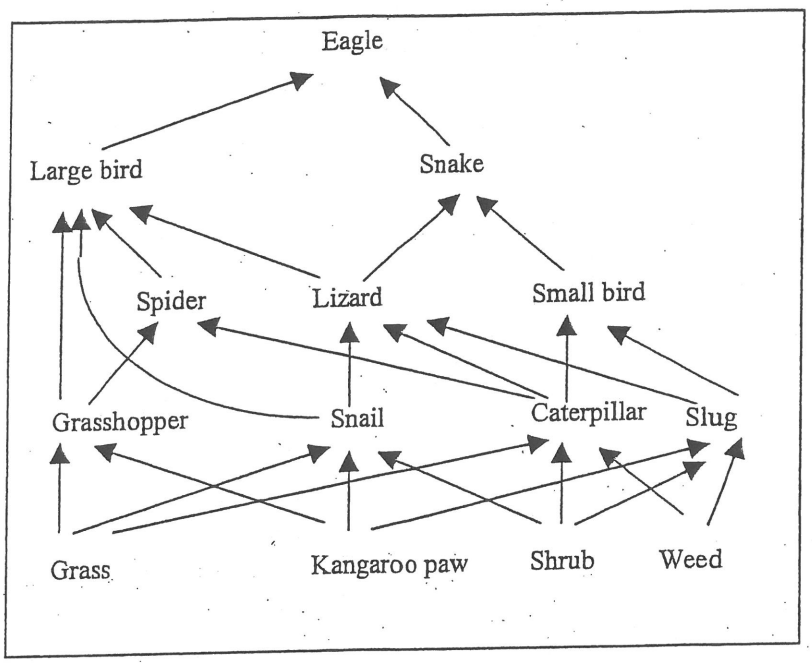
1. What two things do the arrows show?
2. List the prey species of the eagle.
3. What are the predators of the rabbits?
4. If the disease myxamatosis killed all the rabbits, what effect would this have on the population of the following animals? Give a reason in each case.

   a. Eagles
   b. Grass
   c. Bandicoots

5. Why would there be more bandicoots than foxes in this community?
6. Draw a food pyramid of one food chain in the food web.

Food webs (continued)

Study this diagram of a food web then answer the questions which follow.



1. List the producers in this food web.
2. List the herbivores.
3. What are the carnivores?
4. What is the only omnivore?
5. What is the top predator?
6. What are the predators of the lizard?
7. Which animals fall prey to spiders?
8. If all the grasshoppers and snails were poisoned, what would happen to the population of large birds?
9. If all the herbivores died, what would happen to the numbers of carnivores? Give a reason.
10. Name the species that are predators of the spider.
11. What is the food source of the caterpillar?
12. Are any decomposers shown on this food web?
13. Which organisms would best take the place of the small bird: frog, flower or fox.
14. In this community, are there likely to be more snakes or more lizards?